of days of toxic alchemical treatment. Should anything interrupt the tempering process for more than 24 hours, it must start again from the beginning.

Detailing. Although the basic shape of the weapon has been created, the item is still far from complete. Magic weapons are masterful pieces of artistry, possessing intricate details that put lower-quality weapons to shame. Rare gems, leather grips, inscribed glyphs, and magical enchantments are examples of the final flourish that brings a magical weapon to life. Each one is a testament to the skill of its crafter, bearing the telltale signatures of its creator's hand in its every edge and angle. Those rare few who can craft legendary, extraordinary and mythic items are among the finest artisans in all the realms. Their craftsmanship can be recognized on sight, and are highly prized by collectors and adventurers alike.

Sample Weapon

The following example has been created from the rules presented here and serves as a sample of what kind of items can be created using this system.

+1 Quicksilver Pike of Phasing

Weapon (pike), extraordinary (requires attunement)

Composition. This weapon is composed of magical silver mined on seven different planes and combined into a single alloy.

Temper. This weapon was tempered on a demiplane. Every 24 hours it was transported through a magical portal, with each passage slowly distorting and warping its composition.

Detailing. This weapon's tip is sharpened to a needle point, and its shaft spirals in a quadruple helix. The grip is bound in leather from an astral dreadnought, and its pommel faceted with a black pearl carved into the shape of an eye.

Enchantments

Enhancement. This weapon grants a +1 bonus to attack and damage rolls made with it.

Quicksilver. This weapon has the finesse property, and while you hold the weapon your movement does not provoke attacks of opportunity.

Phasing. This weapon can open magical portals, allowing you to make attacks against enemies from a safe distance. As a bonus action you can open a small magical entrance portal within 5 feet of you and another magical exit portal within 5 feet of an unoccupied space you can see within 60 feet. Both portals last until the end of your turn. If you are within 5 feet of the entrance portal, you can make attacks through it against any targets within reach of your weapon as though you were in the space occupied by your exit portal.

Enchantment

Magical weapons have mystical enchantments that grant them unique properties. The effects of these properties and the increase they apply to a weapon's rarity are detailed here. They are presented alphabetically, include the rarity increase bonus in parentheses after the enchantment name, and outline restrictions on the type of weapon to which the enchantment can be applied. Some enchantments even exist at higher rarities, improving their effects in accordance with increases in their rarity. Note that a weapon cannot benefit from a single enchantment more than once.

Aid (+2) – Ranged Weapon Only. When you would make an attack with this weapon, you can choose to instead fire a bolt of healing energy at a creature of your choice you can see within range. The target regains a number of hit points equal to the weapon's damage dice, and you roll a d20. On a 20, roll the weapon's damage dice twice and add them together, and the target then regains that may hit points. Once you have fired twenty healing bolts in this manner, you cannot fire any more until 24 hours have passed.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this weapon increase the number of healing bolts the weapon can fire, along with the amount of hit points a target regains when struck by a bolt. With a +4 increase in rarity, the weapon can fire an additional ten healing bolts every 24 hours, and the amount healed by a single bolt is doubled. With a +6 increase in rarity, the weapon can fire an additional twenty healing bolts every 24 hours and the amount healed by a single bolt is tripled.

The Ledger of Legends

The Everslate Market: An Exposé on the Most Sought-After Material in Nexus

You may have heard of the legendary indestructible material everslate. But did you know what it takes to acquire such extraordinary material? Our reporters have gone undercover to expose one of the most dangerous, lucrative, and absurd markets in Nexus, and our findings will shock you.

Know that the properties of everslate are no exaggeration. The material is truly indestructible, enduring divine power, overwhelming magic, and natural forces with equal obstinance. Understandably, anything that possesses such properties is valuable beyond measure. Here in the Steel Streets the cost of a single pound of unprocessed everslate is paid in blood, wealth, and the exceeding expertise required to shape it.

This paper has uncovered a vast conspiracy to corner and control the market of everslate. What appears to be a simple gang-run enterprise has its connections to our highest members of city government. Even the Sheriffs are not exempt from implication, as this author can exclusively reveal Lord Drax is seeking a shipment of everslate to further equip the already formidably armed Dread Guards. Just how deep does this web of lies and intrigue go? Find out in next week's issue and learn the truth.

Avenging (+1). While you hold this weapon and take damage from a creature, you can use your reaction to make one attack with the weapon against the creature if it is within range or reach of the weapon. If the attack would miss the target, it instead hits.

Binding (+2). When this weapon deals damage to a creature, it must succeed on a DC 16 Wisdom saving throw or become cursed. While cursed in this manner, a creature cannot magically teleport or travel between planes.

Biting (+2) – Melee Weapon Only. When you hit a creature with this weapon, you can immediately take a bonus action to attempt a grapple against the target with the serrated teeth on the weapon. While you are grappling a creature in this manner, you cannot attack another creature with the weapon.

Blinking (+3) – Ranged Weapon Only. When you hit a creature with this weapon you can take a reaction to magically teleport to a random unoccupied space within 5 feet of the target. If there is no unoccupied space within 5 feet of the target, the effect fails.

Brawling (+1) – Melee Weapon Only. When you attune to this weapon it vanishes, and your unarmed strikes become magical weapons. Additionally, if the weapon would cause one or more effects on a successful hit made with it, your unarmed strikes also cause those effects on a successful hit.

Brilliant Energy (+4) – Melee Weapon Only. The striking end of this weapon is made of radiant energy and deals radiant damage instead of its normal damage type.

Additionally, the weapon sheds bright light in a 15-foot radius and dim light for an additional 15 feet.

Finally, the striking end of the weapon passes through most defenses. The target gains no benefits to its AC from shields or armor.

Weapon Item Enchantments (By Rarity, Then Name)

+1 Rarity	+2 Rarity	+3 Rarity	+4 Rarity	+5 Rarity	+6 Rarity
Avenging (+1)	Aid* (+2)	Blinking (+3)	Aid* (+4)	Enhancement* (+5)	Aid* (+6)
Brawling (+1)	Binding (+2)	Cavalry (+3)	Brilliant Energy (+4)	Explosive* (+5)	Doom (+6)
Defending (+1)	Biting (+2)	Contamination (+3)	Devouring (+4)	Fortunes* (+5)	Elemental Power* (+6)
Enhancement (+1)	Cleaving (+2)	Dancing (+3)	Elemental Power* (+4)	Lucky* (+5)	Explosive* (+6)
Hurling (+1)	Concussive (+2)	Devastating (+3)	Enhancement* (+4)	Slaying* (+5)	Hellfire (+6)
Lucky* (+1)	Disruption (+2)	Enhancement* (+3)	Explosive* (+4)	Venomous* (+5)	Holy/Unholy* (+6)
Merciful (+1)	Elemental Power* (+2)	Explosive (+3)	Keen* (+4)	Vorpal (+5)	Keen* (+6)
Quicksilver (+1)	Enhancement* (+2)	Heartfinder (+3)	Nemesis (+4)		Soultaker (+6)
Slaying* (+1)	Execution (+2)	Phasing (+3)	Spellbreaker (+4)		
Sniping (+1)	Faithful (+2)	Slaying* (+3)			
Speed (+1)	Fortunes* (+2)	Spirit (+3)			
Transforming (+1)	Holy/Unholy* (+2)	Storm (+3)			
Twin (+1)	Keen* (+2)	Sundering (+3)			
Venomous* (+1)	Leadership (+2)				
Warning (+1)	Screaming (+2)				
	Seeking (+2)				
	Vampiric (+2)				
	Wounding (+2)				

* Indicates the enchantment is available at multiple rarities

Cavalry (+3) – Melee Weapon Only. This weapon is specialized for mounted combat. When you hit a creature with a with the weapon while mounted, the target is knocked prone and you may immediately take a bonus action to use the shove special attack.

Cleaving (+2) – Melee Weapon Only. When you score a hit with this weapon, you can immediately take a bonus action to target each creature of your choice within range with the attack as well, using the same attack result as the original attack.

Concussive (+2). When you hit a Huge or smaller creature with this weapon, you may push the target up to 10 feet away from you in a straight line. When you score a critical hit against a Huge or smaller creature with this weapon, you may instead throw the target up to 40 feet away from you, and the target lands prone.

Contamination (+3). This weapon is a magical source of a single deadly disease, chosen by the weapon's creator from the following options.

Contamination Weapon Disease

Disease	Effect
Blinding Sickness	Pain grips the target's senses, and its eyes turn milky white. The target has disadvantage on Wisdom checks and Wisdom saving throws and is blinded.
Filth Fever	A raging fever sweeps through the target's body. The target has disadvantage on Strength checks, Strength saving throws, and attack rolls that use Strength.
Flesh Rot	The target's flesh decays. The target has disadvantage on Charisma checks and is vulnerable to all damage.
Mindfire	The target's mind becomes feverish. The target has disadvantage on Intelligence checks and Intelligence saving throws, and the target cannot consider other targets its allies.
Seizures	The target is overcome with shaking. The target has disadvantage on Dexterity checks, Dexterity saving throws, and attack rolls that use Dexterity.
Slimy Doom	The target begins to bleed uncontrollably. The target has disadvantage on Constitution checks and Constitution saving throws. In addition, whenever it is critically hit, it is stunned until the end of its next turn.

Contamination (+3), *Continued*
When you score a hit with this weapon, the target creature is exposed to a deadly and virulent disease. It must succeed on a DC 18 Constitution saving throw or become infected.

Each time you hit such an infected creature with the weapon, it must make a DC 18 Constitution saving throw. Once it has failed three saving throws made in this manner, the symptoms of the disease manifest, which causes the target to suffer its effect. If you do not hit a creature after infecting it with the weapon, the symptoms instead manifest in 1d4 days. If a creature succeeds on three saving throws in this manner, it is cured of the disease before the symptoms manifest.

When an infected creature that is manifesting the symptoms of the disease finishes a long rest, it can attempt a DC 18 Constitution saving throw, curing itself of the disease on a success.

Dancing (+3) – Melee Weapon Only. You can use a bonus action to toss this weapon into the air and speak the command word. When you do so, the weapon begins to hover, flies up to 30 feet, and attacks one creature of your choice within 5 feet of it. The weapon uses your attack roll and ability score modifier to damage rolls.

While the weapon hovers, as a bonus action on your turn you can command the weapon to move up to 30 feet and make an attack against a creature within 5 feet of it.

After the weapon has hovered for 1 minute, it flies up to 30 feet toward you and returns to your hand. If you do not hold the weapon at the end of that movement, it falls.

Defending (+1) – Melee Weapon Only. Before you make an attack with this weapon, you can choose to take a penalty to your attack roll of 1, 2, or 3. If you do this, you gain an Armor Class bonus equal to the penalty taken until the start of your next turn or until the weapon leaves your hand (whichever comes first).

Doom (+6). Creatures cannot be resistant or immune to damage dealt by this weapon.

Additionally, when you fail a saving throw while holding the weapon, you can take a reaction to succeed instead.

Finally, while you are attuned to the weapon you cannot be forcibly compelled or magically manipulated into relinquishing ownership of the weapon.

Cursed. When you attune to this weapon you become afflicted with an Epic curse. While so cursed, you are destined to face an Epic creature of your DM's choice in battle. If you do not defeat the chosen creature within 1 year, you are slain instantly and cannot be returned to life for a period of 10 years. This is a Deific effect.

Devastating (+3) – Melee Weapon Only. When you hit with this weapon, you deal maximum damage on your weapon damage dice against the target.

Additionally, when you attack a creature with this weapon and roll a 20 on the attack, the target takes double damage from the attack and you lop off one of the target's limbs. Which limb is lopped off and the effect of such a loss is determined by the DM. If the target has no limbs to sever, you lop off a portion of its body instead.

Devouring (+4) – Melee Weapon Only. When you hit a Huge or smaller creature with this weapon you can immediately take a bonus action to force the target to succeed on a DC 19 Dexterity saving throw or be devoured by the weapon. A creature so devoured is stored in an extradimensional space within the weapon where it is blinded and restrained. The creature has total cover against attacks and other effects outside the weapon and takes 6d6 acid damage at the start of each of your turns.

A creature so devoured can take an action to attempt a DC 19 Strength (Athletics) or Dexterity (Acrobatics) ability check, freeing itself and appearing in the nearest unoccupied space to the weapon on a success. If the target is slain while devoured by the weapon, you gain a number of hit points equal to half the target's hit point maximum. The weapon can only hold one devoured creature at a time, and if the weapon slays a creature in this manner, it cannot devour another creature until 24 hours have passed.

Disruption (+2). When you hit a nonliving creature (such as a construct or undead) with this weapon, that creature takes an extra 2d6 force damage. If the target has 50 hit points or fewer after taking this damage, it must succeed on a DC 16 Wisdom saving throw or be destroyed. On a successful save, the creature becomes frightened of you until the end of your next turn.

Elemental Power (+2). You can use a bonus action to speak this magic weapon's command word, causing magical energy to wreath the weapon, the type of which is determined at the item's creation (acid, cold, fire, lightning, or thunder). While the weapon is so wreathed, it deals an extra 2d6 damage of the energy's type to any target it hits. The effect lasts until you use a bonus action to speak the command word again or until you drop or stow the weapon.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this weapon increase the elemental damage the weapon deals on a hit. If the rarity increase is +4, the weapon deals an extra 4d6 damage of the energy's type to any target it hits. If the rarity increase is +6, the weapon deals an extra 8d6 damage of the energy's type to any target it hits.

Enhancement (+1). You have a +1 bonus to attack and damage rolls made with this magic weapon.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this weapon increase the bonus to attack and damage rolls. For each increase in rarity, the bonus to attack and damage rolls increases by +1, to a maximum of +5.

Executioner's (+2). This weapon has 9 charges. If you score a critical hit with this weapon against a flesh-and-blood creature that has fewer than 100 hit points, it must succeed on a DC 16 Constitution saving throw or be slain instantly. The weapon loses 1 charge when this effect occurs. When the weapon has no charges remaining it becomes empowered by the lifeforce of those it has slain, granting you a +2 bonus to attack and damage rolls made with it (in addition to the weapon's other properties). The weapon's expended charges cannot be restored.

Explosive (+3) – Ranged Weapon Only. This enhancement imbues a weapon's projectiles with deadly energy. When you hit a target with an attack from the weapon, you can immediately take a bonus action to speak its command word. When you do so the projectile explodes in a 20-foot-radius sphere of magical energy centered on the target.

The energy must also be one of the following types: acid, cold, fire, lightning, or thunder, chosen by the weapon's creator at the time of its creation. Each creature in the area must succeed on a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw, taking 4d6 damage of the energy's type on a failed save, or half as much on a success.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this weapon can deliver attacks with greater explosive power. For each increase in rarity, the Dexterity saving throw DC of the effect increases by 3, and the damage dealt by the explosion increases by 4d6.

Faithful (+2). While you hold this weapon, you cannot be unwillingly disarmed of it unless the limb holding it is removed.

Additionally, as a bonus action you can magically teleport the weapon to your hand across any distance, though not across planar boundaries.

Fortunes (+2). When you kill a flesh-and-blood creature of challenge rating 5 or greater with this weapon, its body explodes in a shower of coins, jewels, and gems worth 10d100 gp. Once this effect has occurred, it cannot occur again until 1 week has passed.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this weapon can produce greater quantities of wealth. Such weapons have a +5 increase in rarity and, instead of the previous effect, create 100d100 gp worth of wealth when used to kill a creature of CR 10 or greater. Once this effect has occurred, it cannot occur again until 1 month has passed.

Heartfinder (+3) – Piercing Weapon Only. When you hit a surprised creature with this weapon, it must succeed on a DC 20 Constitution saving throw or take double damage from your attack.

Additionally, while you hold the weapon you can take a bonus action to learn the current hit points of a single creature you can see within 300 feet of you. Once you have used this feature, you cannot use it again for 24 hours.

Hellfire (+6). While you hold this weapon, you are wreathed in a mantle of blazing hellfire. While so wreathed you cannot be hidden, but you are terrifying to enemy creatures. When an enemy creature starts its turn and can see you, it must succeed on a DC 24 Wisdom saving throw or be frightened for as long as it is within direct line of sight to you.

Additionally, when you score a critical hit with the weapon you roll damage dice three times instead of twice.

Holy/Unholy (+2). When you hit a celestial (if unholy), fiend (if holy), or an undead (either holy or unholy) with this weapon, that creature takes an extra 2d10 radiant damage (if holy) or 2d10 necrotic damage (if unholy).

Additionally, while you hold the weapon it creates an aura in a 10-foot radius around you. You and all creatures friendly to you have advantage on saving throws against spells and magical effects while within the aura.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this weapon are imbued with greater power. Such weapons deal 4d10 radiant (if holy) or necrotic (if unholy) damage on a successful hit against a celestial (if unholy), fiend (if holy), or undead (either holy or unholy). Additionally, the radius of the aura generated by the weapon increases to 30 feet. Such weapons have a +6 increase to their rarity.

Hurling (+1) – Melee Weapon Only. The weapon has the thrown property with a normal range of 20 feet and a long range of 60 feet. When you hit with a ranged attack using this weapon, it deals twice the weapon's damage dice rather than the base weapon damage. If you are not incapacitated, the thrown weapon returns to your hand at the end of that turn.

Keen (+2). Your attacks with this weapon score a critical hit on a roll of 19 or 20.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this weapon score a critical hit on an 18–20. Such weapons have a +4 increase to their rarity. Even rarer versions of this weapon score a critical hit on a 16–20. Such weapons have a +6 increase to their rarity.

Leadership (+2) – Melee Weapon Only. While you hold this weapon, allies within 60 feet of you have advantage on saving throws against being frightened and charmed.

Additionally, while you hold the weapon you can take 1 minute to give a rousing speech. For the duration of that speech you have proficiency in Intimidation and Persuasion, and you have advantage on Charisma ability checks.

Lucky (+1). While this weapon is in your possession, you gain a +1 bonus to all your saving throws. Additionally, your weapon has the following property:

> ***Luck.*** While the weapon is on your person, you can call on its luck (no action required) to reroll one attack roll, ability check, or saving throw, and you must use the result of this roll. This property can't be used again until the next dawn.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this weapon can change reality to improve the fortunes of its wielder. Such weapons have a +5 increase to their rarity and gain the following property:

> ***Wish.*** The weapon has 1d4-1 charges (minimum 1 charge). While holding the weapon, you can use an action to expend 1 charge and cast the spell *wish* from it. Once you have cast *wish* in this manner, this property can't be used again until the next dawn. If the weapon has no charges remaining, it crumbles to dust.

Merciful (+1). When damage from this weapon reduces a creature to 0 hit points, it instead reduces it to 1 hit point, and the creature is knocked unconscious for 8 hours.

Nemesis (+4) – Ranged Weapon Only. When you use this weapon to make an attack, you can designate a creature you can see as your nemesis until it dies or until 24 hours have passed. You can only have one nemesis at a time, and you cannot designate a new nemesis while your current one lives. You have advantage on attack rolls against the nemesis. If your nemesis is hit by the weapon, it takes an extra 3d6 damage. The nemesis gains no benefit from any cover short of total cover against attacks from this weapon, and you don't have disadvantage on attacks against the target due to long range (when applicable).

> **Curse.** The weapon is cursed. While your nemesis lives, you have disadvantage on attack rolls against creatures other than your nemesis.

Phasing (+3) – Melee Weapon Only. This weapon can open magical portals, allowing you to make attacks against enemies from a safe distance. As a bonus action you can open a small magical entrance portal within 5 feet of you and a magical exit portal within 5 feet of an unoccupied space you can see within 60 feet of you. These portals last until the end of your turn, during which time you can make attacks through the entrance portal against any targets within reach of your weapon as though you were in the space occupied by your exit portal.

Quicksilver (+1). The weapon has the finesse property, and while you hold the weapon your movement does not provoke attacks of opportunity.

Screaming (+2) – Ranged Weapon Only. This weapon magically imbues its ammunition with sonic power. When you hit a target with this weapon, the ammunition becomes lodged in the target and emits an earsplitting shriek for 1 minute that can be heard up to 500 feet away. A target under this effect cannot be hidden from creatures that can hear the shriek. A creature can take an action to attempt a DC 16 Wisdom (Medicine) check to remove the ammunition from the target, which causes the shrieking to end immediately.

Seeking (+2). When you miss an attack with this weapon, you instead hit but deal the minimum damage on the attack's damage dice.

Slaying (+1). This weapon is magically enchanted to slay creatures of a specific type (such as dragons, fiends, or undead; creator's choice). When you hit a creature of that type with the weapon, the creature takes an extra 3d6 damage of the weapon's type.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this weapon deal additional damage to creatures of a specific type on a successful hit. Such weapons with a rarity increase of +3 deal an extra 6d6 damage of the weapon's type on a successful hit, while weapons with a rarity increase of +5 deal an extra 9d6 damage of the weapon's type on a successful hit.

Sniping (+1) – Ranged Weapon Only. On each of your turns while you hold this weapon, if you do not spend movement and take no actions other than the Attack action, your range for the weapon is doubled.

Soultaker (+6). This weapon extracts the souls of those it slays, which can be called upon to grant you power.

Whenever you use the weapon to reduce a creature to 0 hit points, the target is slain instantly and the weapon extracts the target's soul, storing it within the weapon. Creatures with their souls stored within the weapon cannot be restored to life by non-Deific means. Destroying the weapon frees all of the souls trapped within.

Additionally, as an action while holding the weapon you can cast *commune* at will, though instead of communicating with a deity you communicate with the souls stored within the weapon.

Finally, if you fill the weapon with one hundred Epic souls, the weapon gains a +6 bonus to attack and damage rolls.

Speed (+1). As a bonus action on each of your turns, you can make one attack with this weapon.

Additionally, while you hold the weapon your speed is increased by 10 feet.

Spellbreaker (+4). This weapon can overcome any magical defense. When you make an attack with the weapon, spells or magical effects cannot impose disadvantage on or reduce the damage of the attack.

Additionally, you may forgo one of your weapon attacks to attempt to end a non-Epic spell or magical effect within reach or range of the weapon. When you do so, make an attack roll as though you were attacking with the weapon. If the result of your attack is greater than 10 plus the spell's level, the effect ends.

Spirit (+3). This weapon is imbued with mystical ki and is always considered a monk weapon.

Additionally, while you hold the weapon, your ki save DC is increased by 2.

Storm (+3) – Ranged Weapon Only. As an action, you can make a ranged weapon attack with this weapon against a creature you can see within range. When you do so, you can choose any number of creatures within range of the weapon that you can see to also be the target of that attack (using the same attack roll as the original target, unless doing so would give you disadvantage on the attack, in which case you make the attack roll again and pick the lower result).

Sundering (+3) – Bludgeoning Weapon Only. Attacks made with this weapon deal double damage to objects and structures.

Sundering (+3) – Bludgeoning Weapon Only, *Continued*
Additionally, when you score a critical hit with this weapon against an object or structure, the spell *earthquake* is cast immediately, centered on the target. You are immune to the effects of this spell, which lasts for its full duration and has a spell save DC of 20.

Transforming (+1). As a bonus action while you hold the weapon, you can transform the weapon into another simple or martial weapon of your choice. Regardless of the form it takes, the weapon retains any magical properties unless such properties would not ordinarily be possible to exist on such a weapon (for example, a *transforming maul of sundering* cannot benefit from its *sundering* property if it assumes the form of a greatsword). In such cases the property is suppressed until the weapon assumes a form that can benefit from the property.

Twin (+1) – One-Handed Melee Weapon Only. While holding this weapon you can take a bonus action to speak its command word, which creates a second, identical weapon. If you do not have a free hand to hold the second weapon it falls to the ground. While you hold both weapons you can take a bonus action to speak its second command word, merging the weapons together as one. If the second weapon leaves your possession for more than 1 hour it vanishes. You can never have more than two of the same weapons at a time using this feature.

Vampiric (+2) – Melee Weapon Only. When you deal damage to a flesh-and-blood creature, you gain temporary hit points equal to half the damage dealt. These temporary hit points last until you finish a short or long rest.

Venomous (+1). As an action while you hold this weapon, you can magically coat it in noxious green poison for 1 minute. When you hit a creature with the weapon while it is coated in poison, the effect ends and the target must succeed on DC 20 Constitution saving throw or take 2d10 poison damage and be poisoned for 1 minute. Once this feature has been used, it cannot be used again for 24 hours.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this weapon exist. Such weapons deal 20d10 poison damage on a failed save, and the target is poisoned for 24 hours. Such weapons have a rarity increase of +5.

Vorpal (+5) – Slashing Weapon Only. Creatures are vulnerable to damage dealt by this weapon.

Additionally, when you attack a creature that has at least one head with this weapon and roll a 20 on the attack roll, you cut off one of the creature's heads. The creature dies if it

Vorpal (+5) – Slashing Weapon Only, *Continued*
cannot survive without the head. A creature is immune to this effect if it is immune to slashing damage, doesn't have or need a head, has legendary actions, or the DM decides that the creature is too big for its head to be cut off with the weapon. Such a creature instead takes an extra 6d8 slashing damage from the hit.

Warning (+1). While this weapon is on your person, you have advantage on initiative rolls. Additionally, you and any of your allies within 30 feet of you can't be surprised unless incapacitated by something other than nonmagical sleep. The weapon magically awakens you and any allies within 30 feet of you if you are sleeping naturally when initiative is rolled.

Wounding (+2). When a flesh-and-blood creature takes damage from this weapon, the creature's hit point maximum is reduced by the amount of damage taken. A creature so afflicted regains hit points lost in this manner when it finishes a short or long rest.

Additionally, when you hit a creature with an attack from this weapon, you wound the target. At the start of each of the wounded creature's turns it loses 1d4 hit points for each time you have wounded it in this manner. At the end of each of its turn's, an affected creature can attempt a DC 16 Constitution saving throw, ending all wounds on a success. Alternatively, a creature within 5 feet of the wounded creature (including itself) can take an action to attempt a DC 16 Wisdom (Medicine) check, ending all wounds on a success.

ARMOR AND SHIELDS

A warrior without armor might as well be naked, though barbarians and monks have been known to disagree. When enhanced by magic, a suit of armor or robust shield can be the most powerful tool in an adventurer's arsenal. They can save the life of even the foolhardiest hero and provide unique improvements to one's combat potential. Presented here is a system for creating customized armors and shields for your campaign. This system includes design and crafting guidelines, determining an item's enhancement bonus, and any enchantments it has.

Armor Crafting and Design

Crafting magical armor requires the skill of an artisan-level blacksmith. In the event a DM allows a character to craft magical armor, certain prerequisites must be met in order to forge the item. Each armor has at least one of the following components as a part of the crafting process in order to be made, in addition to a large amount of time and effort on the crafter's part. Each armor has a composition, a forging, and a detailing. Creating magical armor is more difficult depending on the rarity of the armor, requiring a Wisdom (Artisan's Tools) check and a considerable amount of time. Depending on the nature of the armor, only certain tools may be suitable to create it. A general guide for this process is found in the Magic Armor Creation table.

Magic Armor Creation		
Rarity	**Wisdom (Artisan's Tools) DC**	**Time (In Strenuous Activity)**
Uncommon	12	24 hours
Rare	15	1 week
Very rare	19	1 month
Legendary	24	6 months
Extraordinary	30	1 year
Mythic	40	2 years

Composition. Armor needs to be made of something, and in the case of magical armor, a very special something. The material used to make magical armor can be a mysterious metal that fell from the sky, the scales of an ancient dragon, or even wood from a mystical tree. However, the type of armor may require materials of a specific nature (crafting leather armor cannot be done with alchemically treated gold, for example). What kind of materials are available is unique to each game world but should always be challenging to find and difficult to process into a suitable state for crafting. For examples of materials suitable to create magical armor, consult the Precious Materials table detailed earlier in this chapter.

Forging. Once an armor's base material has been created, it must be shaped in a forging process. This is the most physically intensive and dangerous part of creating shields and armor, requiring a smith (or team of smiths) to apply incredible skill. Such an act can involve anguished hours next to a blazing forge, tanning arcane leather in noxious chemicals, or firing plates of indestructible ceramic with powerful magic. Each process is unique to the intended properties of the armor and the nature of its composition. Creating a *+1 mirrored breastplate* may involve hardening the steel in a forge of blue flame to create the +1 bonus to AC, while the mirrored property might require binding enchanted glass to the metal.

Detailing. Once an armor or shield has been forged, the creator must detail the item to both draw out its magical potential and do justice to its powerful nature. Such detailing often takes the form of inscribed magical runes, masterful artistic carvings, or even socketing gems and other supplemental materials. The detailing of a shield or armor is the signature of its creator and is almost always unique to the crafter's design sensibilities and skills. For example,

Armor and Shield Item Enchantments (By Rarity, Then Name)					
+1 Rarity	**+2 Rarity**	**+3 Rarity**	**+4 Rarity**	**+5 Rarity**	**+6 Rarity**
Aquatic (+1)	Adamantine (+2)	Animated (+3)	Bastion* (+4)	Enhancement* (+5)	Aegis (+6)
Bastion* (+1)	Arrow-Catching (+2)	Blossoms* (+3)	Enhancement* (+4)	Fortification* (+5)	Blossoms* (+6)
Bladed (+1)	Bastion* (+2)	Enhancement* (+3)	Fortification* (+4)	Grandeur (+5)	Enhancement* (+6)
Blinding (+1)	Cavalier (+2)	Etherealness (+3)	Living (+4)	Olympian (+5)	Fortification* (+6)
Elven Weave (+1)	Dragon Scale (+2)	Fortification* (+3)	Resistance* (+4)	Resistance* (+5)	Juggernaut (+6)
Glamoured (+1)	Enhancement* (+2)	Indomitable (+3)	Retribution* (+4)	Retribution* (+5)	Resistance* (+6)
Resistance* (+1)	Enigma (+2)	Invulnerability (+3)		Spellguard* (+5)	Retribution* (+6)
Retribution* (+1)	Ghost (+2)	Mirrored (+3)		Titan (+5)	
	Mithral (+2)	Peace (+3)			
	Phoenix (+2)	Resistance* (+3)			
	Resistance* (+2)	Retribution* (+3)			
	Retribution* (+2)	Shadow* (+3)			
	Sacred (+2)	Spellguard (+3)			
	Seductive (+2)	Wildskin (+3)			
	Shadow* (+2)				
	Survival (+2)				
	Watchful (+2)				
	Zephyr (+2)				

* Indicates the enchantment is available at multiple rarities

dwarves may carve their clan history into armors they forge, while wood elves would embed diamonds in the shape of their fondest constellations into a shield.

Sample Armor

The following example has been created from the rules presented here and serves as a sample of what kind of armor and shields can be created using this system.

+1 Bladed Plate Armor of the Phoenix

Armor (plate), extraordinary (requires attunement)

Composition. This armor is composed of steel stained crimson with dye extracted from phoenix feathers. Its blades are raptor claws harvested from giant eagles.

Forging. This armor was forged in a natural conflagration on the elemental plane of fire using only elements and tools that could be found in the wild. The blades are magically enchanted by a brass dragonborn sorcerer for durability and longevity.

Detailing. Fire elementals detailed the armor, scorching the metal to bring out a spectrum of colors while retaining a natural aesthetic. It is as though the armor was willed into existence by the plane of fire itself.

Enchantments

Enhancement. You gain a +1 bonus to AC while wearing this armor.

Bladed. While wearing this armor you can use it as a weapon which you are considered proficient in. The armor has a reach of 5 feet and deals 1d8 slashing damage on a successful hit.

Phoenix. While wearing this armor you have advantage on death saving throws.

Additionally, if you are killed while wearing this armor, you instead survive and are restored to your hit point maximum. Once this effect has occurred, you cannot benefit from this feature again until 1 year has passed.

Enchantment

Some magical armors have mystical enchantments that grant them unique properties. The effects of these properties and the increase they apply to an armor's rarity are detailed here. They are presented alphabetically, include the rarity increase bonus in parentheses after the enchantment name, and outline restrictions on the type of armor to which the enchantment can be applied. Some enchantments even exist at higher rarities, improving their effects in accordance with increases in their rarity. Note that a magical armor cannot benefit from a single enchantment more than once.

Aegis (+6) – Shield Only. While you are attuned to this shield, whenever you finish a long rest you gain 100 temporary hit points. Additionally, while you hold the shield, you cannot die.

Adamantine (+2) – Metal Armor Only. While wearing this armor, any critical hit against you becomes a normal hit.

Animated (+3) – Shield Only. While holding this shield, you can speak its command word as a bonus action to cause it to animate. The shield then leaps into the air and hovers in your space, protecting you as though you were wielding it and following you as you move. The shield remains animated for 1 minute, until you use a bonus action to end the effect, or until you are incapacitated. If you are able to hold the shield when the effect ends, it returns to your hand, otherwise it falls to the ground.

Aquatic (+1) – Armor Only. While wearing this armor, you have a swimming speed equal to your walking speed. In addition, when you start your turn underwater and have 0 hit points, the armor causes you to rise 60 feet toward the surface.

Arrow-Catching (+2). While wearing this armor or holding this shield, you gain a +2 bonus to AC against ranged attacks (in addition to the item's other bonuses to AC). In addition, whenever a creature makes a ranged attack against a target within 5 feet of you, you can take a reaction to become the target of the attack instead.

Bastion (+1). While wearing this armor or holding this shield, while you are not incapacitated you can provide half cover to any creature of your size or smaller within 5 feet of you.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this armor or shield provide superior cover to creatures of your size or smaller within 5 feet of you. An item that provides three-quarters cover increases the item's rarity to +2. An item that provides three-quarters to creatures of your choice within 10 ft. of you increases the item's rarity to +4.

Bladed (+1). While you wear this armor or carry this shield, it can be used as a weapon which you are considered proficient in. The item has a reach of 5 feet and deals 1d8 slashing damage on a successful hit. If the item is a shield, it also has the thrown property with a range of 20/60.

Blinding (+1) – Shield Only. While holding this shield, you can speak the command word as a bonus action to cause the shield to shed bright light for 60 feet and dim light for an additional 60 feet. When a creature that can see the shield starts its turn in the area of bright light, you can force it to make a DC 16 Constitution saving throw or become blinded for 1 minute. Once a creature has succeeded on a saving throw against this effect, it is immune to the effect for 24 hours. Once you have activated the shield, you cannot activate it again for 24 hours.

Blossoms (+3). This armor or shield is covered in living vines that grow magically. At the start of each dawn while you are attuned to the item, you can command the vines to blossom into a flower chosen from the following options. You gain the benefits produced by the flower until the next dawn.

At Higher Rarites. Rarer versions of this armor blossom with all six flowers. Such armors and shields grant you proficiency in Strength, Dexterity, Constitution, Intelligence, Wisdom, and Charisma saving throws. Such armors and shields have a rarity increase of +6.

Blossoming Flower Effects

Flower	Effect
Dahlia	You have proficiency in Strength saving throws.
Gazania	You have proficiency in Intelligence saving throws.
Lily	You have proficiency in Charisma saving throws.
Lotus	You have proficiency in Wisdom saving throws.
Orchid	You have proficiency in Dexterity saving throws.
Rose	You have proficiency in Constitution saving throws.

Cavalier (+2). While you wear this armor or hold this shield, are not incapacitated, and are mounted, you reduce all damage your mount takes by half (rounded down).

Additionally, when you roll initiative and your mount has an Intelligence of 3 or greater, you can choose to have it take its turn immediately before, during, or after your turn.

Dragon Scale (+2) – Scale Mail Only. While wearing this armor, you have advantage on saving throws against dragons and are immune to one type of damage that is determined by the kind of dragon that provided the scales. This damage type is always the same damage type as the dragon's breath weapon (if the dragon's breath weapon deals multiple types of damage, the creator of the armor chooses which type).

Additionally, you can focus your senses as an action to magically discern the distance and direction to the closest dragon within 30 miles of you. Once you have used this feature, you cannot use it again for 24 hours.

Elven Weave (+1) – Armor Only. You are considered proficient with this armor, even if you would ordinarily lack proficiency.

Additionally, you can don and doff the armor in half the normal time.

Enhancement (+2). You gain a +1 bonus to AC while wearing this armor or holding this shield.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this weapon increase the bonus to AC while wearing the armor or holding the shield. For each increase in rarity, the bonus to AC increases by +1, to a maximum of +5.

Enigma (+2) – Armor Only. While wearing this armor, any distinguishing traits you possess are magically concealed, making you indistinguishable from an ordinary and unremarkable member of your species.

Additionally, creatures cannot sense your thoughts, establish telepathic contact with you, or detect you with spells from the Divination school.

Etherealness (+3) – Armor Only. While wearing this armor, you can speak its command word as an action to gain the effect of the *etherealness* spell. This effect lasts for 10 minutes, until you remove the armor, or until you speak the command word again. Once you have used this property, you cannot use it again for 24 hours.

Fortification (+3) – Armor Only. While wearing this armor, you reduce damage you take from weapon attacks by 5.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this armor increase the damage reduction from weapon attacks. For each rarity increase, the damage reduced increases by 5.

Ghost (+2) – Armor Only. While wearing this armor, your form is ghostly and transparent. You can move through other creatures and objects as though they were difficult terrain. If you end your turn inside an object, you are immediately shunted to the nearest unoccupied space and take 1d10 force damage for every 5 feet moved in this manner.

Glamoured (+1) – Armor Only. While wearing this armor, as a bonus action you can speak the armor's command word and cause it to assume the appearance of a normal set of clothing or other kind of armor. You determine the armor's appearance—including color, style, and accessories—but the armor retains its normal bulk and weight. The illusion lasts until you use this property again or remove the armor.

Grandeur (+5) – Armor Only. While wearing this armor, your Intelligence, Wisdom, and Charisma scores increase by 2, as does your maximum for each score. Additionally, enemies that can see you wearing the armor have disadvantage on attack rolls against you.

> **Curse.** This armor is cursed. While wearing this armor, you cannot be hidden or invisible, and you cannot willingly attack a surprised creature.

Indomitable (+3). While you wear this armor or hold this shield, are not incapacitated, and are on the ground, you cannot be pushed, thrown, dragged, magically teleported, or otherwise forcibly moved from your space against your will.

Invulnerability (+3). While wearing this armor or holding this shield, you have resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical attacks. Additionally, you can take an action to make yourself immune to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical attacks for 10 minutes or until you are no longer wearing the armor or holding the shield. Once this feature has been used, it can't be used again for 24 hours.

Juggernaut (+6) – Armor Only. While wearing this armor, you can expend 15 feet of movement to deal 100 bludgeoning damage to an unattended object or structure within 5 feet of you. Additionally, while wearing the armor your speed cannot be reduced.

Living (+4) – Armor Only. This armor is alive and exists in a symbiotic relationship with its wearer. While wearing the armor, your hit point maximum increases by 50. Additionally, you magically regain 50 hit points when you don the armor. Once you have regained hit points in this manner, you cannot do so again until you finish a long rest.

Finally, while wearing the armor you have advantage on saving throws that would cause you to be poisoned, stunned, or unconscious on a failure, and you are immune to disease.

Mirrored (+3). While wearing this armor or holding this shield, if you are targeted by an attack, spell, or effect that targets only you, you can take a reaction to change the target to another creature of your choice that you can see within range. If there are no other eligible targets within range, the effect fails. Once you have used this feature, you must finish a short rest before you can use it again.

Mithral (+2) – Metal Armor Only. This armor does not impose disadvantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks and does not have a Strength requirement. Additionally, if the armor has a maximum Dexterity bonus to AC, that bonus maximum is increased by 2.

Olympian (+5) – Armor Only. While wearing this armor, your Strength, Dexterity, and Constitution scores increase by 2, as does your maximum for each score. Additionally, while you wear the armor, your carrying capacity is multiplied by 10.

> **Curse.** This armor is cursed. While wearing the armor, you cannot gain benefits from short rests. If you remove the armor, this effect persists for 24 hours or until you finish a long rest, whichever comes first.

Peace (+3). While wearing this armor or holding this shield, creatures will not willingly attack you or affect you with harmful effects unless you have attacked or subjected them to a harmful effect within the last 24 hours. A creature immune to the charmed condition is immune to this effect.

Phoenix (+2) – Armor Only. While wearing this armor, you have advantage on death saving throws.

Additionally, if you are killed while wearing this armor, you instead survive and are restored to your hit point maximum. You cannot benefit from this feature again until 1 year has passed.

Resistance (+1). While wearing this armor or holding this shield, you have resistance to one type of damage of any of the following types, determined by the item's creator: acid, cold, fire, force, lightning, necrotic, poison, psychic, radiant, or thunder.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this armor or shield gain an additional resistance to one type of damage chosen from the specified options. For each additional damage type, the rarity of the armor increases by 1. An armor or shield of this type that attains mythic rarity in this manner grants resistance to all the damage types listed in this enchantment.

Retribution (+1) – Armor Only. While wearing this armor, a creature that touches you or hits you with a melee attack while within 5 feet of you takes 1d6 damage of one of the following types, determined by the item's creator: acid, cold, fire, lightning, or thunder.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this armor increase the damage dealt to creatures that touch or hit you. For each rarity increase, the damage dealt by the armor increases by 1d6.

Sacred (+2). This armor or shield is dedicated to a powerful deity and inscribed with wards against an alignment, chosen by the item's creator: chaotic, evil, good, lawful, or neutral. While wearing the armor, creatures of that alignment have disadvantage on attack rolls and ability checks against you.

Additionally, at the start of each of your turns if you are below half your hit points maximum, you regain 5 hit points.

Seductive (+2) – Armor Only. While wearing this armor, you have proficiency in Charisma (Persuasion) checks, and your proficiency bonus is doubled for any ability check you make using Persuasion.

Additionally, while wearing the armor, when you spend 1 minute in private conversation with another creature it must succeed on a DC 18 Wisdom saving throw or become charmed by you for 1 hour. At the end of the effect, a creature charmed in this manner becomes aware it was under the influence of magic.

Finally, the armor is always considered appropriate formal wear for any gathering within high society.

Shadow (+2) – Armor Only. While wearing this armor, you are invisible while completely within darkness.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this armor make the wearer invisible in both dim light and darkness. Such armors have a rarity increase of +3.

Spellguard (+3). While wearing this armor or holding this shield, you have advantage on saving throws against spells and magical effects, and creatures have disadvantage on spell attacks against you.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this armor or shield provide superior protection against magic. In addition to the +3 properties, while wearing the armor or holding the shield you have resistance to damage from spells and magical effects. Such items have a rarity increase of +5.

Survival (+2) – Armor Only. While wearing this armor, you are immune to the effects of nonmagical weather, including extreme cold, extreme heat, and other natural effects. The armor supplies an hour of breathable air if you are in an environment where you cannot breathe and grants you darkvision out to a range of 300 feet.

Additionally, by speaking the command phrase (no action required), the armor magically produces enough food and water to sustain you for 48 hours in the form of bland nutrient bars. Once you have used this feature, you cannot use it again until a week has passed.

Titan (+5) – Plate Armor Only. While wearing this armor, your speed cannot be greater than 15 feet, and your Armor Class is 23.

Additionally, you are immune to spells and magical effects of 6th level or lower unless you wish to be affected.

Curse. This armor is cursed. If your Strength is ever less than 20 while wearing the armor, you are incapacitated, and your speed cannot be greater than 0.

Watchful (+2) – Shield Only. While holding this shield, you have truesight out to 60 feet and advantage on initiative rolls and Wisdom (Perception) checks.

Wildskin (+3) – Armor Only. If you change your shape into another creature while wearing this armor, you can choose to have the armor appear on your new form, shaped and suited for a creature of its dimensions and type. Doing so grants you the armor's bonuses and penalties while in that form.

Zephyr (+2) – Armor Only. While wearing this armor, you have a flying speed equal to your walking speed, but only when you are moving. If you end a turn in the air and nothing else is holding you aloft, you immediately fall.

The Ledger of Legends

Controversial Assassin to Be Interred within the Eternal Flame

We've all heard the tales of the infamous, exceptional, and honorable assassin aptly titled The Invisible Blade. Just the other night at my favorite tavern, the song "Crimson Sunrise" was performed to universal approval from the audience. The ballad is well loved in Nexus, detailing The Invisible Blade's extraordinary act of assassinating an entire noble house of vampires by morning. It brings me great sadness to see so many protesting the scheduled interment of the late assassin within the Eternal Flame. While I can see why one would question the worthiness of one who fights with suspicious honor, one cannot mistake the nobility in The Invisible Blade's intent. Even if there is some doubt, who are we to decide? To doubt the judgment of the flame is to question its virtue, a crime far more egregious to our fair district than honoring a figure some deem controversial.

ARCANA

Spellcasters have little use for arms and armor. Instead they call upon impressive arcane weaponry that better complements their fighting style. These items take the form of staffs, rods, and wands and can possess a wide array of formidable properties. Presented here is a system for adding these weapons to your game.

Spell Save DC and Spell Attack Bonus By Rarity

Arcana Item Rarity	Spell Save DC/Spell Attack Bonus
Uncommon	DC 11/+3
Rare	DC 12/+4
Very Rare	DC 14/+6
Legendary	DC 16/+8
Extraordinary	DC 19/+11
Mythic	DC 22/+14

The following section details the kind of properties these items can have and a process for creating custom items. This system includes design and crafting guidelines as well as instructions on determining an item's enhancement bonus, its spellcasting trait, and any enchantments it may have.

Note that arcana items are intended for characters and creatures with the ability to cast spells. Many of their enchantments and effects force affected targets to make saving throws and spell attacks without providing a specific save DC or spell attack bonus. The spell save DC and spell attack bonus is always the same as the wielder's unless they do not have one. In that case, spell attack bonus and spell save DC by rarity is detailed in the table on the left.

Arcana Crafting and Design

Crafting arcana items is an art that can only be performed by those of exceptional talent and powerful magic. In the event a DM allows a character to craft an arcana item, certain prerequisites must be met to contain the potent magic within. Each arcana item has at least one of the following components that must be supplied in crafting process, in addition to a large amount of time and effort on the crafter's part. Each arcana has a core, a body, and a focus.

Arcana Item Enchantments (By Rarity, Then Name)

+1 Rarity (Uncommon)	+2 Rarity (Rare)	+3 Rarity (Very Rare)	+4 Rarity (Legendary)	+5 Rarity (Extraordinary)	+6 Rarity (Mythic)
Arcana* (+1)	Bestial* (+2)	Arcana* (+3)	Bestial* (+4)	Archdruid (+5)	Colors* (+6)
Colors* (+1)	Brotherhood (+2)	Colors* (+3)	Colors* (+4)	Archmagi (+5)	Elder* (+6)
Elementalist* (+1)	Channeling (+2)	Elementalist* (+3)	Cosmic Control (+4)	Colors* (+5)	Infection* (+6)
Enhancement* (+1)	Colors* (+2)	Enhancement* (+3)	Dread (+4)	Elder* (+5)	Spellcasting (Zenith) (+6)
Mischief (+1)	Death (+2)	Life (+3)	Geomancy (+4)	Hierophant (+5)	Striking* (+6)
Spellcasting (Minor) (+1)	Detonation (+2)	Miraculous Mayhem (+3)	Spellcasting (Supreme) (+4)	Spellcasting (Ultimate) (+5)	Time* (+6)
	Enhancement* (+2)	Mysteries (+3)	Songs (+4)	Striking* (+5)	
	Infection* (+2)	Pact Making (Masterful) (+3)	Striking* (+4)	Time* (+5)	
	Secrets (+2)	Spellcasting (Masterful) (+3)			
	Spellcasting (Greater) (+2)	Striking* (+3)			
	Striking* (+2)	Storms (+3)			
	Toxic (+2)	Vermin (+3)			

* Indicates the enchantment is available at multiple rarities

Core. Because an arcana item generates its own magic, that energy must come from somewhere. The core of the arcana *is* that somewhere and the most vital part of any design. An arcana core is typically a component from a powerful creature, carefully harvested, preserved, and finally processed before finally integrated into the arcana item's design. Such components are typically thematic to the arcana item—a *staff of the fire elementalist* that casts several fire spells may have phoenix down as a core, or even the ground heart of an ancient red dragon. The challenge rating of the creature that provides the component is roughly proportional to the rarity of the item, as detailed in the Arcana Core Component by Rarity table.

Arcana Core Component by Rarity

Rarity	CR Creature Component Range
Uncommon	6–8
Rare	9–12
Very rare	13–17
Legendary	18–23
Extraordinary	24–30 or Epic 1–10
Mythic	Mythic 1–10

Body. An arcana item's body makes up the majority of its composition and is typically crafted from rare materials that are magical in nature. The wood of a treant, stone from a dwarven tomb, or even the bones of a lich are all examples of suitable material. The rarer the arcana item, the more unusual and difficult to find the material of its body. Most body materials are thematic to the nature of the item. For example, a *staff of the archdruid* should not be made from demon leather, with catastrophic consequences for even attempting to put such an abomination together.

Focus. Every arcana item needs a channel through which its magical energy can be focused. For most, this takes the form of a gem or precious material faceted to the item's head. Such materials must be carefully treated, polished, or cut to best focus magical energies. The rarer the item, the more expensive the focus (see the Arcana Focus Component by Rarity table for details).

Arcana Focus Component by Rarity

Rarity	Focus Cost Average
Uncommon	1,000 gp
Rare	5,000 gp
Very rare	10,000 gp
Legendary	16,000 gp
Extraordinary	23,000 gp
Mythic	100,000 gp

Sample Arcana

The following example has been created from the rules presented here and serves as a sample of what kind of items can be created using this system.

+2 Greater Spellcasting Staff of the Fire Elementalist

Staff, extraordinary (requires attunement)

Core. A carved fang of a balor serves as the core for this staff.

Body. The body of the staff is carved from rosewood stained in the fiery blood of efreeti. Words of power are carved across the body in the language of Ignan.

Focus. A fire opal molded into the shape of the sun serves as the focus of the staff and is embedded in the staff's head.

Enchantments

Enhancement. While you are attuned to this staff, you have a +2 bonus to spell attack rolls and your spell save DC.

Fire Immunity. While you hold this staff, you are immune to fire damage.

The staff has 20 charges and regains 1d6 + 2 charges every 24 hours.

Spells. You can use an action to cast one of the following spells from the staff, expending a number of charges according to the spell used. You use your spell save DC and spell attack bonus for spells you cast with the staff.

Cantrips: *control flames*[1] (0 charges), *firebolt* (0 charges)

Other Spells: *fire shield* (4 charges), *fireball* (3 charges, plus 1 charge per spell level beyond 3rd, up to 6th level), *gaseous form* (3 charges), *hellish rebuke* (1 charge, plus 1 charge per spell level beyond 1st, up to 6th level), *investiture of flame*[2] (6 charges), *scorching ray* (2 charges, plus 1 charge per spell level beyond 2nd, up to 6th level).

[1] This spell can be found in the official 5E supplement, *XGE*.
[2] This spell can be found in the official 5E supplement, *XGE*.

Spellcasting

Some arcana items can be used to cast spells. Such items have charges and a list of spells that can be cast using those charges. To cast a spell with the arcana item, a creature must be holding it and must be attuned to the item.

Casting a spell with the arcana item takes an action and expends a number of charges equal to the level at which the spell is cast (cantrips can be cast at will, while Epic spells require 11 charges for a tier 1, 14 for a tier 2, or 18 for a tier 3 Epic spell), up to the maximum spell level permitted by the item. You can cast spells from an arcana item at higher levels, provided you have enough charges to do so and you do not exceed the item's maximum spell level. Such an arcana item has a number of charges according to its spellcasting capacity and regains a number of charges every 24 hours, also according to its spellcasting capacity. If an arcana item with charges ever reaches 0 charges, its core burns out and the item permanently loses its spellcasting feature.

Arcana Spellcasting Capacity

Name	Spell Level	Number of Charges	Spells "Known"	Charge/ Recharge Rate	Rarity Increase
Minor	Cantrips–3rd	10	4	1d4 + 1	+1
Greater	Cantrips–6th	20	8	1d6 + 2	+2
Masterful	Cantrips–8th	30	13	1d8 + 3	+3
Supreme	Cantrips–9th	50	20	1d12 + 4	+4
Ultimate	Cantrips–Tier 2 Epic	70	20 non-Epic and 3 Epic	1d12 + 8	+5
Zenith	Cantrips–Tier 3 Epic	100	24 non-Epic and 7 Epic	20	+6

The capacity for an arcana item's spellcasting feature increases its rarity according to the Arcana Spellcasting Capacity table, and as such an item "knows" a number of spells according to its capacity. When the item is created, the creator indicates what kind of spells they would like the item to know, typically from a general theme (such as fire, healing, or necromancy). The DM then decides what spells an item knows, which can never be at a higher level than the arcana item is able to cast. Spells can be chosen from any class spell list and require no material components in order to be cast.

Enchantment

Some arcana have mystical enchantments that grant them unique properties. The effects of these properties and the increase they apply to an item's rarity are detailed here. If the effects of an arcana require charges in order to be used, it must have a spellcasting feature that grants it enough potential charges to make use of that enchantment. Some enchantments even exist at higher rarities, improving their effects in accordance with increases in their rarity. Note that a arcana item cannot benefit from a single enchantment more than once.

Arcana (+1) – Requires Charges. While you wield this arcana, you are protected against a certain school of magic, determined by the item's creator: abjuration, conjuration, divination, enchantment, evocation, illusion, necromancy, or transmutation.

While holding the item, when you fail a saving throw against a spell from the item's school you can take a reaction to expend 5 charges to turn your failed save into a success.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this item afford great protection against magic. When you wield this item, when you fail a saving throw against a spell from any school you can take a reaction to expend 5 charges to turn your failed save into a success. Such items have a rarity increase of +3.

Archdruid (+5) – Staff Only. While this staff is on your person or absorbed into the form of a creature you take, you retain your class Spellcasting feature regardless of whatever form you assume. Additionally, spells you cast using that feature with a casting time of an action or bonus action can be cast without the need for somatic, verbal, or material components.

Finally, while you hold the staff, beasts are always friendly toward you unless they are your enemies.

Archmagi (+5). While you hold this item, you are immune to non-Epic spells and magical effects produced by creatures with a spellcasting ability score lower than yours.

Additionally, while you hold this item, creatures with an Intelligence score lower than yours have disadvantage on saving throws against spells and magical effects produced by you.

Bestial (+2) – Staff Only. You can use an action to speak the staff's command word and throw it to the ground within 10 feet of you. The staff immediately becomes a specific beast of CR 5 or lower, loyal to you, which is determined by the staff's creator at the time of its creation. You can take a bonus action to speak the command word again to return the staff to its normal form in a space formerly occupied by the beast.

On your turn you can mentally command the beast as long as it is within 60 feet of you and you aren't incapacitated. You decide what actions the beast takes and where it moves during its next turn, or you can issue it a general command, such as "attack my enemies" or "guard this location."

If the beast is reduced to 0 hit points, it dies and the staff reverts to its normal form. Once the staff has transformed into the beast or the beast is killed, it cannot transform again until 24 hours have passed.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this staff can transform into a specific beast whose CR is between 6 and 10. Such staffs have a rarity increase of +4.

Brotherhood (+2) – Wand Only. As a bonus action, you can split the wand into two parts, each of which you must hold in a free hand. You can cast spells with somatic components while holding both parts of the wand. Additionally, when you cast a spell with a casting time of 1 action, you may use the magic of the wand to cast that spell again as a bonus action (provided you have the necessary spell slots and components to do so). If you drop a part of the wand while it is split, the wand is made whole but cannot be split again until 24 hours have passed.

Channeling (+2) – Requires Charges. This enchantment allows you to convert the item's charges into non-Epic spell slots, or vice versa. As a bonus action while you hold the item, you can expend a number of its charges to gain a special unexpended non-Epic spell slot of a level equal to the number of charges expended. This spell slot lasts until you finish a short or long rest, until 24 hours have passed, or until you use this feature again. You cannot gain a spell slot in this manner of a level greater than the highest-level spell slot you can cast using a spellcasting class feature.

Additionally, as a bonus action while you hold the item you can convert your highest-level unexpended non-Epic spell slot into charges for the item. The item regains a number of charges equal to the spell slot's level but can never have a number of charges greater than its maximum.

Colors (+1). This enchantment endows an item with one of the following colors, determined by its creator at the time of its creation: red, orange, yellow, green, blue, indigo, or violet.

As an action while you hold the item, you fire a ray of color by making a spell attack against a creature you can see within 300 feet. On a hit, the target is affected by the color according to the following list.

- **Red.** The target takes 10d6 fire damage.
- **Orange.** The target takes 10d6 acid damage.
- **Yellow.** The target takes 10d6 lightning damage.
- **Green.** The target takes 10d6 poison damage.
- **Blue.** The target takes 10d6 cold damage.
- **Indigo.** The target is restrained for 1 minute. It must then make a Constitution saving throw at the end of each of its turns. If it successfully saves three times, the effect ends. If it fails its save three times, it is permanently turned to stone and petrified. The successes and failures need not be consecutive.
- **Violet.** The target is blinded. It must then make a Wisdom saving throw at the start of your next turn. A successful save ends the blindness. If it fails that save, the creature is transported to another plane of existence of the DM's choosing and is no longer blinded.

Once this item has used one of its colors in this manner, it cannot use that color again until 24 hours have passed.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this item have multiple colors. For each color beyond the first, the staff has a +1 increase to its rarity. Staffs of mythic rarity have all seven colors and are typically called "prismatic" or "prism" items.

Cosmic Control (+4) – Rod Only. While you hold the rod, you can take an action to expend a spell slot to generate a single powerful magical phenomenon of a celestial nature, chosen from the following options.

- **Black Hole.** You cause a dark singularity to appear in an unoccupied space you can see within 120 feet. The singularity generates a powerful gravitational field in a 10-foot-radius sphere plus an additional 10 feet per level of the spell slot expended to produce the effect. Everything not firmly attached to the ground in the area must succeed on a DC 20 Strength saving throw or be pulled to the nearest unoccupied space to the singularity.
- **Comet.** A comet descends from the sky and lands on a point you can see within 300 feet, producing an explosion in a 30-foot-radius sphere. Anything in the area of the explosion must succeed on a DC 20 Dexterity saving throw or be knocked prone and take 1d10 fire and 1d10 bludgeoning damage, plus an additional 1d10 fire and 1d10 bludgeoning damage per level of the spell slot expended to produce the effect, or half as much on a success.
- **Shooting Star.** A radiant star projects from the rod and strikes a creature you can see within 60 feet, dealing 5d4 + 5 radiant damage. This effect produces an additional star per level of the spell slot expended beyond 1st level, which can strike the same target or another creature within range.

Death (+2). While you are holding this item, spells and magical effects affect you as though you were undead instead of your normal creature type. Additionally, undead of an Intelligence of 4 or lower are friendly toward you unless they are your enemies, and you have advantage on Charisma ability checks against undead with an Intelligence of 5 or higher.

Finally, if you are slain while holding the item and your body remains intact, you rise as a undead in 24 hours at your maximum hit points. As an undead you no longer need to eat, drink, or breathe, your creature type changes to undead, and you have immunity to poison damage and resistance to necrotic damage.

Dread (+4). While you are holding the item, you have advantage on Charisma (Intimidation) checks against creatures that can hear you.

Additionally, at the start of each of your turns you can issue a decree (no action required) to any number of creatures that can hear you. Until the start of your next turn if a creature that heard you attempts to do anything that would violate your decree, it must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw or become frightened for as long as you can see it.

Detonation (+2) – Requires Charges. While you are holding this item, as an action you can destroy it and generate a colossal explosion in a 60-foot-radius sphere centered on it. Creatures in the affected area must succeed on a Dexterity saving throw against your spell save DC or take force damage equal to 20 multiplied by the number of charges the item has remaining, or half as much on a success. Objects and structures in the area take this damage automatically. Anything reduced to 0 hit points by this effect is disintegrated. If you succeed on this saving throw, you instead take no damage and are transported to a random plane of existence somewhere in the multiverse.

If the item is ever destroyed while it has charges, this effect occurs immediately.

Elder (+5) – Wand Only. While you are holding this wand, non-Epic spells of 1st level or higher that you cast are treated as though you had cast them at four levels higher, up to a maximum of 9th level.

Cursed. The wand is cursed. The creator of the wand immediately becomes attuned to the wand upon its completion. Additionally, you can only become attuned to the wand by killing a creature already attuned to it. Once you attune to the wand, you cannot become unattuned unless you are killed by an enemy creature.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this wand are deadly tools that are exceptional for magical dueling. While holding such a wand, if you are affected by a spell you can choose to expend a spell slot or Epic spell slot (no action required) of the affecting spell's level or Epic spell tier. When you do so, you become immune to the affecting spell for its duration. These wands are often called "hallowed elders" and have a rarity increase of +6.

Elementalist (+1). While holding this item you are immune to one type of elemental damage, determined by the item's creator at the time of its creation, chosen from the following options: acid, cold, fire, lightning, or thunder.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this item also absorb elemental energies. While holding such an item, when you would take elemental damage of the chosen type, in addition to the damage immunity you may take a reaction to gain temporary hit points equal to half the damage you would have taken (rounded down, before applying your damage immunity). These temporary hit points last until you finish a short or long rest. Such items have a rarity increase of +3.

Enhancement (+1). While you hold this item, you have a +1 bonus to spell attacks, and your spell save DC increases by 1.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this item increase the bonus to spell attack rolls and your spell save DC. For each increase in rarity, the bonus to attack and save DC increases by +1, to a maximum of +3.

Geomancy (+4). While you hold this item, you have a burrowing speed equal to your walking speed, can travel through solid rock in this manner as though it were difficult terrain, and have tremorsense out to a range of 60 feet.

Additionally, while holding this item, when you cast a spell that must affect an area on the ground you can choose to double the dimensions of the affected area.

Hierophant (+5) – Staff Only. While holding this staff, you can take an action to call down a pillar of energy in a 5-foot-radius cylinder that extends infinitely into the sky. When you do so, you must expend a number of spell slots whose combined slot level cannot be greater than your character level. Creatures of your choice within the area of the cylinder must succeed on a Constitution saving throw versus your spell save DC or take 1d8 radiant or necrotic damage (your choice) per level of the combined spell slots expended, or half as much on a success.

Additionally, while you hold the staff, you can spend 1 hour of strenuous activity entreating a deity or godlike entity you worship for aid. Should the deity answer your call, the spell *wish* is cast on your behalf as though you had cast it (causing you to suffer any stress effects caused by the *wish)*. The first time you use this feature in a year, the call is always answered. Once you have used this feature, you cannot use it again until 1 month has passed.

Infection (+2). While holding this item, when you affect a single enemy creature with a spell with a duration of 1 minute or greater, you can choose to increase the duration of the spell to 1 month. If you use this feature again while a previous spell's duration is increased in this manner, the previous spell immediately ends.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this item allow you to infect your enemies with even more virulent magic. When you increase the duration of spell using this item, previous spells benefiting from this effect end. Additionally, when you increase the duration of a spell using this item, you can choose to increase the duration to permanent. When you do so, the affected spell immediately ends if you use this feature again. Arcana items such as this have their rarity increased by +6 and are often titled "pandemic" items.

Life (+3). While holding this item, when you magically cause a creature to regain hit points, the creature regains the maximum amount of hit points possible from the magical effect.

Additionally, while the item is on your person, your proficiency bonus is doubled for any Wisdom (Medicine) ability checks you make.

Miraculous Mayhem (+3). While holding this item, as an action you can point it at a creature within 120 feet of you that you can see. You decide whether the effect will be weal or woe, rolling a d10 and consulting the Miraculous Mayhem table. If an affected target must make a saving throw, the DC is always equal to your spell save DC or a DC appropriate for the item's rarity according to the Spell Save DC and Spell Attack Bonus By Rarity table detailed earlier in this section, whichever is higher.

Each time you use this feature, you must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw. The DC of this saving throw is 10 but increases by 1 for each time you have succeeded on the saving throw. The increase to the save DC resets when you finish a long rest. On a failure, the magic of the item retaliates against you, subjecting you to each woe effect from the Miraculous Mayhem table simultaneously and instantly.

Miraculous Mayhem Table

d10	Weal Effect	Woe Effect
1	The target's walking speed is increased by 100 until the end of its next turn.	The target is thrown 3d100 ft. in a straight line in a random direction. If the target encounters something that would prevent its movement, the effect ends and the target takes 1d6 bludgeoning damage for every 10 ft. of movement prevented.
2	A meal of nutritious pasta force-feeds itself to the target, equivalent to one day's rations. The target is cured of any poisons and immediately regains 10d10 hit points.	The target is entangled by ropes of thick pasta noodles, becoming restrained for as long as it is entangled by the noodles. The noodles are an object with an AC of 8 and 40 hit points and are vulnerable to piercing damage.
3	The target is encased in a giant balloon (AC 10, 1 hp), granting it a flying speed of 60 ft. (hover). The balloon is transparent, and the creature inside has total cover against everything outside the balloon, and vice versa.	The target must succeed on a Constitution saving throw or inflate to comical proportions for 1 minute. While so inflated, the creature's base walking speed cannot be higher than 15, and it cannot take the Dash action.
4	The target's weapon attacks are imbued with jubilant energy for 1 minute. When the target scores a critical hit with the affected weapon, the target of the attack takes an additional 2d10 radiant damage from the attack and is blinded until the end of its next turn.	The target must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw or be cursed for 1 minute. While so cursed, when the target would score a critical hit on a melee weapon attack, it instead attempts to give its target a hearty pat on the back, provoking an attack of opportunity in the process.
5	The target is invisible to enemy creatures for 1 minute.	The target is invisible to allied and friendly creatures for 1 minute.
6	The target is surrounded with a sweet, pleasant aroma in a 30-ft.-radius sphere for 1 minute. Creatures in the area have advantage on Constitution, Intelligence, and Wisdom saving throws.	The target is afflicted with a catastrophic stench for 1 minute. A creature so afflicted must succeed on a Constitution saving throw at the start of each of its turns or be unable to take actions and instead spend that time retching. A creature that cannot smell is immune to this effect.
7	The target begins dancing with extraordinary grace for 1 minute. Attacks against the creature have disadvantage, and the creature's movement does not provoke attacks of opportunity. Additionally, the target has advantage on Dexterity saving throws and ability checks. This effect ends early if the target becomes grappled, incapacitated, or restrained.	The target must succeed on a Dexterity saving throw or slip on a physics-defying banana peel and fall prone. When the target falls prone, it is buried in an avalanche of bananas, which deal 10d10 bludgeoning damage to the target before vanishing.
8	Until the start of the target's next turn, the next attack it makes can target any number of creatures of its choice within 120 ft.	Until the end of its turn, anything the creature tries to hold falls out of its grip, and it cannot grapple other creatures.
9	The target's size category increases to Gargantuan for 1 minute, and its equipment magically enhances to accommodate its new size for the duration. A creature so enlarged has a Strength of 30 until the effect ends.	The target must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw or have its sized reduced to Tiny for 1 minute. A creature so reduced has a Strength of 4.
10	The target explodes in a cataclysm of fire, vanishing along with all its equipment. At the start of the creature's next turn it reappears, slightly smoldering, in an unoccupied space of your choice within 120 ft. When the target reappears, it is restored to its hit point maximum.	The target is cursed to be struck by lightning for 1 minute. When the target takes an action, it must succeed on a Dexterity saving throw or take 6d6 lightning damage, or half as much on a success.

Mischief (+1) – Wand Only. This wand doubles as a set of Thieves' Tools and can be used to perform any task those tools would be able to perform using only the hand holding the wand.

Additionally, while you carry the wand on your person but do not hold it, the wand cannot be discovered by creatures searching you unless you will it.

Mysteries (+3) – Rod Only. While you hold this rod, non-Epic creatures cannot remember your name or specific details about you. Epic creatures attempting to remember your name or specific details about you must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw against your spell save DC, becoming immune to the item's effects for 1 hour on a success.

Additionally, as an action you can touch a creature within reach with the rod that has asked you a question to which you do not know the answer. If the creature knows the answer, it communicates the answer to you immediately by the most efficient method possible. If the target is not willing to be touched by the rod, you must make a melee spell attack using the rod as a part of the action, gaining the benefits on a successful hit.

Pact Making (+3) – Rod Only. While holding this rod, you have a +10 bonus to Charisma ability checks against celestials and fiends.

Additionally, as an action while you hold the rod you can cast *magic circle*, *gate*, and *planar binding* instantaneously and exclusively in that order. Both *gate* and *planar binding* must be targeted inside the *magic circle.* The *magic circle* is always inverted (to contain the creature you call with *gate*), and the creature you call with *gate* must always be a celestial or fiend. Once you have used this feature, you cannot use it again until 1 week has passed.

Secrets (+2). While you hold this item and are hidden, you can cast a spell with only verbal components in an inaudible whisper, preventing you from revealing your location through sound and allowing you to remain hidden (though the effects of the spell may still reveal your location).

Additionally, as a bonus action, you can tap the item on an object or on a Medium or smaller creature within reach and magically disguise it as something else. The object takes on an appearance of one of similar size but is otherwise indistinguishable from the form it takes, fooling even tactile and auditory senses. You can affect up to seven objects or creatures simultaneously with this feature. If you affect an eighth object or creature, you choose which one of the other affected objects or creatures will assume its normal form.

Striking (+2) – Staff Only. This staff can be wielded as a magic quarterstaff that grants a +2 bonus to attack and damage rolls made with it.

When you hit a target with the staff, you can expend a spell slot of 3rd level or lower to deal force damage to the target in addition to the weapon's damage. The extra damage is 1d6 for each spell level of the slot expended.

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this staff increases the maximum spell slot level you can expend for extra force damage on a hit. This maximum level of spell that can be expended using the staff is increased by one for each increase in the staff's rarity.

Songs (+4). While you hold this item, you always speak in a melodic tone.

Additionally, when you cast a spell that would target a creature you can see, you can instead target a creature that can hear you within range.

Storms (+3). While you hold this item, you are always under the effect of a *control weather* spell for as long as you have line of sight to the sky.

Additionally, while the item is on your person and when you cast a spell that would deal cold, fire, necrotic, or radiant damage, you can choose to instead deal lightning or thunder damage.

Finally, while you hold the item, when a creature fails a Constitution saving throw against a spell you have cast and takes lightning or thunder damage on a failure, it must succeed on a DC 17 Constitution saving throw or be stunned until the end of its next turn.

Time (+5). While you are attuned to this item, you are immune to the effects of aging and cannot be magically aged.

Additionally, while you hold the item, you have either two bonus actions or two reactions (determined by the item's creator at the time of its creation).

At Higher Rarities. Rarer versions of this item grant you two bonus actions *and* two reactions instead of one or the other. Such items are titled "aeonic" and have a rarity increase of +6.

Toxic (+2). While you hold this item, you are immune to poison damage and the poisoned condition.

Additionally, while the item is on your person, when a creature fails a saving throw against one of your spells it becomes poisoned for 1 minute. While poisoned in this manner, a creature loses 5d10 hit points at the start of each of its turns and can make a Constitution saving throw against your spell save DC at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on a success. A creature who has succeeded on a saving throw against this effect is immune to it for 24 hours.

Vermin (+3). While you hold this item, you are surrounded by a cloud of buzzing vermin in a 15-foot-radius sphere that moves with you and is centered on you. The area is heavily obscured for creatures other than you, though a wind of 10 miles per hour or greater disperses the vermin and suppresses the effect for as long as the winds are present in the area.

Additionally, immediately after you cast a spell with a range of touch, you can take a bonus action to send out a swarm of insects to deliver the spell. When you do so, you must designate a target whose position you are aware of within 60 feet of you, to which the swarm flies by the most direct route. If the swarm takes damage en route to the target, it dies and the spell fails. If the swarm reaches the target, it delivers the spell as though you had been in range of the target.

Walking the Streets

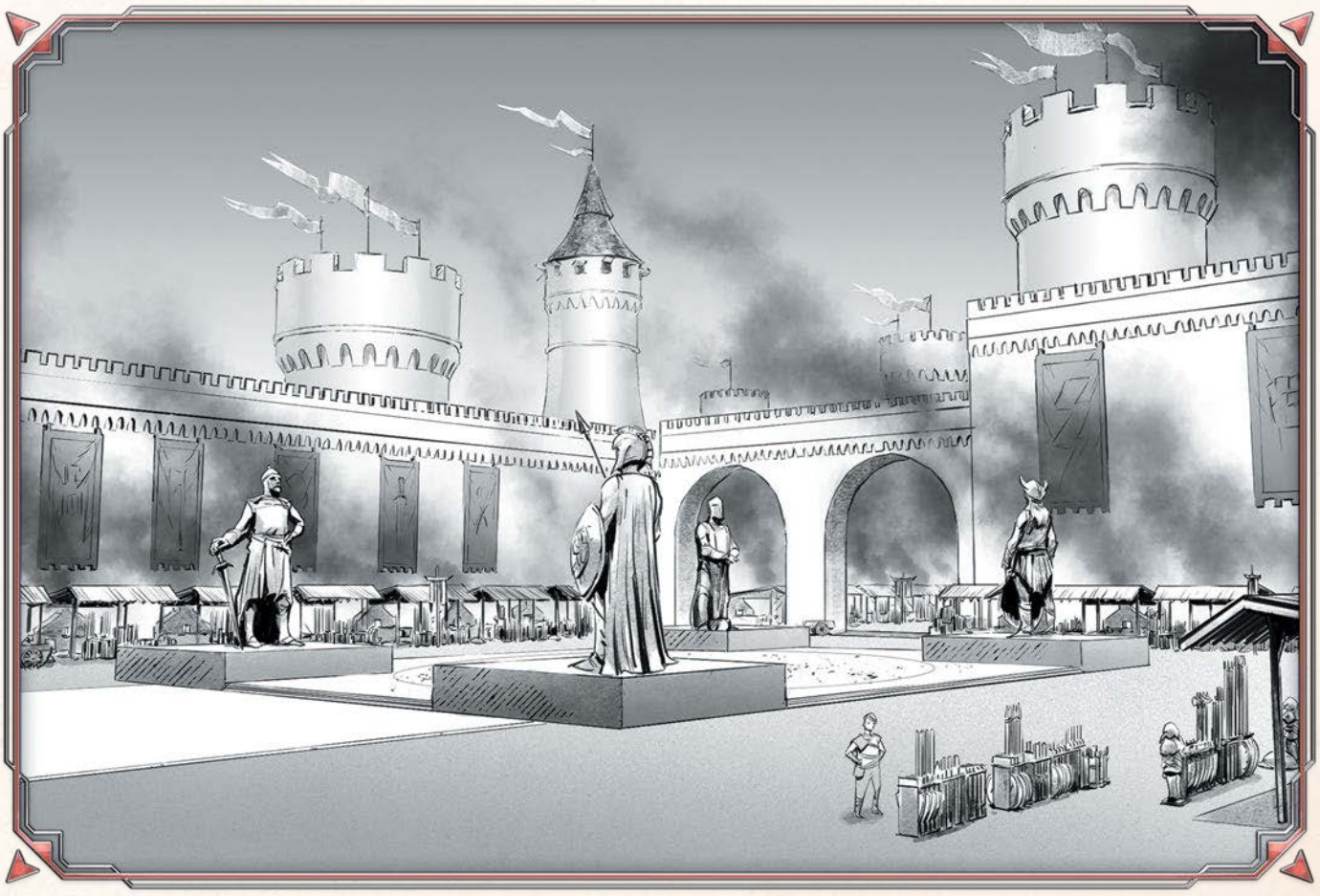
Taking a stroll down the Steel Streets is like exploring a military encampment. Everyone is armed and armored, while the sounds of clanging steel echo at all hours. The air is thick with the smoke of a thousand blacksmiths and the smell of smoldering steel, blood suffusing every surface. The people of the Steel Streets are loud and proud. No one is afraid to get in a fight, and boisterous crowds gather when warriors of considerable skill square off in public. Many come to the Streets just to watch fights, hoping to learn from the expertise on display or pillage the bodies of the slain. Things rarely get that far, however. The violence of the Streets is akin to the competition of intense athletes, overwhelming and intimidating to those unfamiliar with such passion but ultimately all in good fun. Throughout the district there are many places worth your time. Ancient weapon masters instruct worthy students while contests of strength and skill are as popular as any bar. The following locations are a few of many such places one can visit in the Steel Streets.

Notable Landmarks

The following landmarks are presented in alphabetical order.

The Bladestone

A towering obelisk carved from a mysterious stone, this landmark is the source of a grand competition in the Steel Streets. Great warriors from countless worlds have tried to make their mark upon the bladestone, striking it with terrific force. However, the stone magically recovers from all damage except for the greatest single blow it has ever received. Most fail to make more than a scratch in the stubborn object, but every now and again figures of Epic power try their luck. Such an event is a big deal in the Streets—shops close and crowds form, eager to see if the new hopeful has what it takes. Any weapon can be used to strike the great stone,



The Steel Streets